

HOUSE No. 857

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

James M. Murphy

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act increasing voter participation in primary elections.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>James M. Murphy</i>	<i>4th Norfolk</i>	<i>1/15/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 857

By Representative Murphy of Weymouth, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 857) of James M. Murphy for legislation to establish a special commission (including members of the General Court) to investigate ways to increase voter participation in primary elections. Election Laws.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 710 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act increasing voter participation in primary elections.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 A special commission is hereby established pursuant to section 2A of chapter 4 for the
2 purpose of making an investigation and study relative to increasing voter participation in primary
3 elections. Said commission shall specifically investigate the implementation of a “Top Two
4 Primary system” as well as party convention rules relative to party nominations of candidates,
5 primary election dates, and the elimination of the current party primary election system. The
6 commission shall consist of 2 members of the senate, 1 of whom shall be appointed by the
7 Senate President, 1 of whom shall be appointed by the minority leader, 1 of whom shall act as
8 co-chairperson; 2 members of the house of representatives, 1 of whom shall be appointed by the
9 speaker of the house of representatives, 1 of whom shall be appointed by the minority leader 1, 1
10 of whom shall act as co-chairperson; the secretary of the commonwealth or their designee; the

11 president of the Massachusetts Town Clerks' Association or their designee; the president of the
12 Massachusetts City Clerks' Association or their designee; the executive director of Common
13 Cause Massachusetts or their designee; and 1 person from each of the political parties as defined
14 in section 1 of chapter 50 of the General Laws eligible to conduct primary elections at the next
15 following biennial state election.

16 Said commission shall report to the general court the results of its investigation and study
17 and its recommendations, if any, together with drafts of legislation necessary to carry its
18 recommendations into effect, by filing the same with the clerk of the senate and the clerk of the
19 House of Representatives six months after the enactment of this legislation.